scheduled for the following day be convened immediately, which was agreed to and we met at 1130 hours the same day, i.e. 30 August. It was evident from the PLA's actions that they were up to no good and their actions were not matching their words. In fact, in a hotline message sent on the morning of 29 August, they had categorically said that in the interest of stability, there should be 'no mountain manoeuvres', especially at night. Having sent that message, probably to lull us into a false sense of security, that is precisely what they did the same night itself. Such perfidy!

It became clear that in the face of such provocations, we too had to carry out some actions to make the PLA rethink their creeping tactics and teach them a lesson. This involved carrying out actions on both the North and South Banks of the Pangong Tso. On the South Bank, our troops had occupied some of the important heights along the ridge line to where it merged into the Spanggur Gap, an international high mountain pass on the LAC, at an altitude of 4350 m. Since both sides had been racing to the top, the situation on this Ridge was that portions were with the PLA, while the majority was with us, including Gurung Hill and Magar Hill, which dominated the Spanggur Gap from the North. By now, we had also inducted the HQ of 17 Corps, the Mountain Strike Corps, under Lt Gen Savneet Singh, along with some of their supporting elements. All the additional forces we had inducted as part of Operation Snow Leopard, were placed under the command of this Corps. We thus had 14 Corps looking after the defence of the Corps Zone and spearheading the talks, while 17 Corps was exclusively tasked with offensive operations. This was a much neater arrangement rather than having the same Corps looking after both defensive and offensive aspects.

On the North Bank, we decided to send troops through Finger 3 to occupy the higher reaches of Finger 4, thereby

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